

a real-life plane so accurately that it could be used to teach flying! Naturally having such detail and realism makes the game almost impossible to play without first reading the manual and/or practicing a lot. Microsoft Flight Simulator, Falcon 4.0 and IL2-Sturmovik are some of the popular games in this genre.

6) Role Playing Games

Also referred to as RPGs, they usually place you in a fantasy universe, where the game moves forward based on the players interaction with his environment. Further each character is given a particular set of skills, which he can improve as the game progresses. Popular RPGs include Diablo, Final Fantasy and the Star Wars: Knights Of The Old Republic series.

MMORPGs have arisen in recent times as an offshoot of RPGs. These are online games where thousands of players can interact with each other in the same virtual world. Most of them are subscription based and are available only in specific areas. EverQuest, World Of Warcraft, The Matrix Online and Ragnarok are popular MMORPGs

Keep in mind though, that these are only broad generalizations. Some games borrow heavily from more than 1 genre, and some cannot even be placed into any genre. A gamer's personal choices also play a part here, therefore making it next to impossible to definitively mark out and define the various genres.

5.52 Online Games

Ever since the advent of broadband internet, online gaming has become very popular. No matter how good the Artificial Intelligence (AI) of a game is, it can never match up to a human mind. Thus online gaming has become the ultimate arena for gamers around the world. It has become an arena where modern day gladiators learn the tricks of the trade and master their skills.

Online gaming really took off when broadband internet became a reality for most people. This allowed smooth gameplay,